

when the lid was blown off the worst scandal in corporate India's history. But why just blame one man for this fraud? Aren't others like the PwC auditors and bankers also punishable for this fiasco? To check irregularities of such magnitude, we need better corporate governance and severe punishments for defaulters.

DR VITULL K. GUPTA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Slumdog Rising

India's slum story which was otherwise considered an underdog has managed to rake in millions and also win accolades and awards across the globe for its powerful storytelling, brilliant performances and nuanced direction ("Million-dollar Baby", January 19). Danny Boyle and his team handled the subject deftly and celebrated the spirit of Incredible India in *Slumdog Millionaire*.
AMRIT KUMAR MOHANTY,
via www.indiatoday.in

Reptile Row

The callous approach of the authorities to human casualty is appalling ("Mangrove Nightmare", January 26). These poor villagers, who live in and around the Bhitarkanika National Park and depend on the river to earn their living, often fall prey to the ferocious reptiles. Why aren't the authorities doing anything to ensure the

safety and security of the villagers or are they happy shedding crocodile tears over the loss of life?

MANINI MISHRA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Talking Heads

Where were these people who are now telling us to "do this" and "do that", when terror struck us ("What Should be Done", January 19)? People at the helm of affairs were primarily responsible for the sorry state of our intelligence and security appa-

people who can think "out-of-the-box" to do away with the gross ineptitude in our vital systems, time and again.

C. PRABHAKARAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

Post Script

People who are keen on pursuing political careers should avoid being appointed as the president, vice-president, Lok Sabha speaker and state governors ("Fury of the Patriarch", January 26). These distinguished posts



“The apathy of the Central and the state Government over the Bihar flood relief operations has claimed more lives than the Kosi. Is there an end to dirty politics over tragedy?”

AMITABH KUNDU, via www.indiatoday.in

ratus that led to the horrific terror attack in Mumbai. When in office, these people did nothing other than amassing huge wealth and cultivating political patronage to stay afloat. We don't need "trench warfare specialists" and "armchair terror experts" who are just sayers, not doers. We need

are apolitical in nature and require a neutral and impartial approach. Anyone keen on pursuing political dreams shouldn't accept such posts, and if they do so, they should retire gracefully from active politics after their term ends.

ANISHA MURTHY,
via www.indiatoday.in

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Power Trial

The chief judicial magistrate's court in Patna normally handles routine cases. But last month magistrate Birendra Misra heard an explosive case involving state chief minister Karpoori Thakur, food minister Mahavir Prasad, inspector general of police Rajeshwar Lal and Baidyanath Pandey, Janata Party member of the Legislative Council. Premlata Rai, 35-year-old schoolteacher from Kathmandu, told the court that Thakur had raped her while hiding in Nepal during the Emergency. She further complained that she was wrongfully confined when she visited Patna and that Thakur had conspired with others to obtain her signatures. Rai, who claims to have been Thakur's girlfriend, had been shadowing him ever since he became the chief minister. Thakur's alleged affair with her came to light for the first time when he was contesting the Phulparas assembly by-election in January 1978.

Farzand Ahmed

